

Long a vs. Short a

Two sounds, lots of words!

LONG A

The long **a** sound says

="ā"=

like the **a** in **cake**.

♥ SPELLING PATTERNS ♥

Long a can be spelled in many ways!

a

a-e

ai

ay

eigh

ey

≡ EXAMPLES ≡



cake



sail



rain



hay



lane



sleigh

TIP! ♥

When you hear the long a sound, think of its name: "ā" (say its name!)

SHORT A

The short **a** sound says

="ă"=

like the **a** in **cat**.

♥ SPELLING PATTERNS ♥

Short a is usually spelled with a single **a**.

a

≡ EXAMPLES ≡



cat



hat



map



jam



bag



fan

TIP! ♥

When you hear the short a sound, it is quick and short—like in "cat"!

Listen carefully. Look at the letters.
Practice makes perfect!

Long e vs. Short e

Same letter, different sound!

LONG E

The long e sound says

“ē”

like the e in **me**.

♥ HOW IT'S SPELLED ♥

The long e sound can be spelled in many ways!

e ee ea e_e

ie ey ei y

EXAMPLES



tree



cake



leaf



feet



shield



key



monkey



candy

TIP! ♥

When you hear the long e sound, it usually says its name: “ē” (like in **me**)!

SHORT E

The short e sound says

“ĕ”

like the e in **bed**.

♥ HOW IT'S SPELLED ♥

The short e sound is usually spelled with a **single e**.

e

EXAMPLES



bed



red



hen



net



pencil



leg



fence



ten

TIP! ♥

When you hear the short e sound, it is quick and short—like in “**bed**”!

Listen carefully. Look at the letters.
Practice makes perfect!



Long i vs. Short i

Same letter, different sound!

LONG i

The long i sound says

≡ ī ≡

like the i in **bike**.

♥ HOW IT'S SPELLED ♥

The long i sound can be spelled in many ways!

i	i_e	ie	igh
y	y_e	ei	ey

≡ EXAMPLES ≡

 bike	 kite	 die	 light
 fly	 pie	 night	 monkey

TIP! ♥

When you hear the long i sound, it usually says its name: "ī" (like in **bike**)!

SHORT i

The short i sound says

≡ ĭ ≡

like the i in **pig**.

♥ HOW IT'S SPELLED ♥

The short i sound is usually spelled with a **single i**.

i

≡ EXAMPLES ≡

 pig	 fish	 zip	 milk
 tip	 pizza	 wig	 tissue

TIP! ♥

When you hear the short i sound, it is quick and short—like in "pig"!

Listen carefully. Look at the letters.
Practice makes perfect!





Long o vs. Short o



Same letter, different sound!

LONG O

The long o sound says



like the o in go.

HOW IT'S SPELLED

The long o sound can be spelled in many ways!

o	o_e	oa	ow
oe	oo	ou	ow

EXAMPLES

 go	 boat	 road	 snow
 home	 bone	 story	 rainbow

TIP!

When you hear the long o sound, it usually says its name: "o" (like in go)!

SHORT O

The short o sound says



like the o in dog.

HOW IT'S SPELLED

The short o sound is usually spelled with a single o.



EXAMPLES

 box	 frog	 pot	 socks
 top	 dog	 corn	 mop

TIP!

When you hear the short o sound, it is quick and short—like in "dog"!



Same letter. Different sound.
Great readers listen to the sound!





Long u vs. Short u



Same letter, different sound!

LONG U

The long **u** sound says

≡ ū ≡

like the **u** in **cube**.

♥ HOW IT'S SPELLED ♥

The long **u** sound can be spelled in many ways!

u

u_e

ue

ui

oo

ew

ou

eu

≡ EXAMPLES ≡



cube



flute



blue



unicorn



moon



screw



new



fruit

TIP! ♥

When you hear the long **u** sound, it usually says its name: "ū" (like in **cube**)!



SHORT U

The short **u** sound says

≡ ŭ ≡

like the **u** in **cup**.

♥ HOW IT'S SPELLED ♥

The short **u** sound is usually spelled with a **single u**.

u

≡ EXAMPLES ≡



cup



sun



duck



bus



bug



mud



rug



cupcake

TIP! ♥

When you hear the short **u** sound, it is quick and short—like in "cup"!



Same letter. Different sound.
Great readers listen to the sound!

